Subject: Strategic Questions About Representation Transition Timeline - Request for H Bui Law Firm's Input
From: Eric B Jones <eric@recovery-compass.org>
To: Nuha Sayegh <nuha@recovery-compass.org>
Date Sent: Tuesday, October 28, 2025 4:44:46 PM GMT-07:00
Date Received: Tuesday, October 28, 2025 4:44:46 PM GMT-07:00

Dear Ms. Zhou and Ms. Bui,

Thank you for the retainer agreement dated October 27, 2025. I'm writing on behalf of my client, Nuha Sayegh, regarding the timing of potential representation transition. We have several strategic concerns that require your professional input before Ms. Sayegh can make an informed decision.

BACKGROUND:

Ms. Sayegh's case involves three active proceedings in LA County Superior Court (Pasadena):

Case 25PDFL01441: Dissolution proceeding

Case 25PDRO01260: Domestic violence restraining order (DVRO) dismissed October 15, 2025 - Ms. Sayegh prevailed as respondent

Case 25PDRO01246: Related DVRO matter

Current attorney (Kirk A. Kolodji, Esq.) has:

Filed three strategic motions on October 27, 2025:

- FC §6344 attorney fees motion ($14,473.64 - requesting opposing party pay)
- Notice of Lis Pendens (family residence protection)
- FC §271 sanctions notice (frivolous conduct penalties)

CRITICAL TIMELINE CONCERNS:

We have two pressing deadlines that require your assessment:

1. IMMEDIATE DEADLINE: November 1, 2025 (Friday - 3 days)

Opposition brief due to opposing party's Motion for Reconsideration (CCP §1008)

Brief must include newly secured expert medical testimony (two physicians confirming no cosmetic procedures performed)

This evidence directly rebuts opposing party's primary defense claim

2. CONTESTED HEARING: November 19, 2025 (22 days)

Combined hearing on: attorney fees (FC §6344), child support, spousal support, custody/visitation, property possession

Current attorney has invested 65.5 hours, filed all necessary motions, familiar with Judge Lofton (Dept. L)

QUESTIONS FOR H BUI LAW FIRM:

Question 1: November 1 Deadline Management

If Ms. Sayegh retains your firm immediately (pays retainer this week), can your firm:

Review approximately 50+ case documents within 48 hours?

Prepare and file opposition brief to Motion for Reconsideration by November 1 deadline?

Coordinate with two medical experts to obtain declarations by November 1?

OR would your firm request a continuance of the November 1 deadline?

Question 2: November 19 Hearing Preparation

With only 22 days until a complex, contested hearing involving five separate issues:

What is your typical onboarding timeline for a case of this complexity?

Would 22 days provide sufficient time for your firm to prepare at the level of excellence Ms. Sayegh deserves?

OR would your firm recommend retaining you post-November 19 to ensure adequate preparation time?

Question 3: Transition Coordination

If transition occurs now:

How would your firm coordinate with current attorney regarding:

FC §6344 motion already filed (Ms. Sayegh's potential $14,473 recovery from opposing party)?

Lis pendens already recorded (family home protection)?

FC §271 sanctions notice already served?

Would these motions need to be re-filed, or can your firm adopt them via substitution of counsel?

Question 4: Financial Considerations

Current attorney has outstanding balance of $10,473.64, BUT has filed motion for opposing party to pay $14,473.64 under FC §6344(a) (mandatory fee award to prevailing party in DVRO cases).

If this motion succeeds (likely, given Ms. Sayegh prevailed and opposing party has demonstrated ability to pay at $48,000/month income):

Ms. Sayegh's debt would be eliminated

Opposing party would pay the fees directly

Timing question:

If Ms. Sayegh switches attorneys before November 19 hearing, does she still benefit from current attorney's FC §6344 motion?

OR would substitution of counsel affect the fee recovery?

Question 5: Strategic Recommendation

Given the above facts, what is your professional recommendation?

Option A: Retain H Bui Law Firm immediately

Pros: CFLS expertise, client's preference for new representation

Cons: November 1 deadline risk, November 19 preparation constraints, transition complications

Option B: Retain H Bui Law Firm post-November 19

Pros: Current attorney completes pending motions, adequate onboarding time, no deadline pressure

Cons: 22-day delay in representation transition

Option C: Hybrid approach (co-counsel, limited scope, etc.)

Your firm's assessment of viability

ADDITIONAL CONTEXT:

Ms. Sayegh's Current Situation:

Income: $0/month (unemployed during dissolution)

Expected relief from November 19 hearing: $7,000-$12,000/month (child + spousal support)

Financial pressure: Retainer payment of $7,500 represents significant immediate expense with zero current income

Ms. Sayegh's Priorities:

- Securing child and spousal support (November 19 hearing critical)
- Protecting $1.1M-$1.5M family home (lis pendens filed)
- Recovering attorney fees from opposing party (FC §6344 motion filed)
- Ensuring children's welfare (custody/visitation protection)
- Excellent legal representation going forward

REQUEST:

We respectfully request your firm's professional assessment of the above questions. Your honest evaluation will help Ms. Sayegh make the best decision for her case.

Specifically:

Can your firm effectively manage the November 1 deadline if retained this week?

Is 22 days sufficient preparation time for November 19 hearing?

What is your recommendation regarding optimal transition timing?

We are not asking you to decline representation. We are asking for your professional judgment on timing to ensure Ms. Sayegh receives the excellence she deserves from your firm.

If your assessment is that post-November 19 retention would better serve Ms. Sayegh's interests (allowing adequate onboarding time and avoiding deadline pressure), we would greatly respect that professional opinion and plan accordingly.

If your assessment is that immediate retention is viable without compromising quality, please explain how your firm would manage the November 1 and November 19 deadlines.

RESPONSE TIMELINE:

Given the November 1 deadline urgency, we respectfully request your response by end of day Wednesday, October 30, 2025 (48 hours).

This will allow Ms. Sayegh to make an informed decision based on your professional input.

CLOSING:

Ms. Sayegh is impressed by your firm's credentials (CFLS certification is exceptional) and your retainer agreement is professional and fair. She wants to work with your firm.

The only question is WHEN - immediately or post-November 19 - and we defer to your professional judgment on what best serves her case.

Thank you for your consideration of these timing concerns. We look forward to your response.

Respectfully,

Eric Brakebill Jones

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